

Cover to *Civil War #7* by Steve McNiven, Dexter Vines, and Morry Hollowell

without a real fight. "Something that we at Marvel have been dreaming about for a long time is bringing Spider-Man into the context of the Marvel Cinematic Universe," Moore says. "When we were able to find a deal with Sony, it meant that Spider-Man got to join all of the Avengers in the same way that he has in Publishing for years."

The Russos were specific in how and why Spider-Man would make his inaugural appearance. "We had a very strong point of view of what we wanted to do with the character in this film, and what we felt Marvel and Sony should do with the character moving forward," Joe Russo says. "We were very aggressive on the casting front, looking for the right actor, the right age. I felt it was better to go much younger and to not have somebody who was 30 years old playing a 16-year-old. It was more important to find somebody more age-appropriate who would convey that energy—that naivete that would come from being that age and having that kind of power. We also thought it was really interesting to take that naivete and smash it into the cynicism of Tony Stark. What better way to bring that character into the MCU than through Tony Stark?"

With all of these characters intricately maneuvering through a complex and compelling story, the question remains: Who is the real villain? Past films have clearly defined the villain's motivations and intentions. However, the Russos were determined to make a film in which everyone was a "little bit right and a little bit wrong," Joe Russo says.

"The story of Civil War is primarily about the conflict between Captain America and Iron Man, and between the sides that agree with each of them based on this mandate that is coming down from the governments of the world," Feige says. "At the same time, we are introducing another villain; there is somebody who is operating in the shadows, and while not responsible for the events that lead up to *Civil War,* is fanning the flames and is utilizing the conflict to his own advantage. That's something that is going to have a very unique element not unlike the thriller elements of *Captain America: The Winter Soldier* that carries through into *Civil War,* and it does give a very different dynamic to the heroes who at a certain point are realizing, 'We're fighting each other, but there's something else happening here; somebody is using the fact that we're fighting each other to their advantage.' He's a very different kind of villain. We wanted to see what it would it be like for a villain to take on the Avengers without throwing a single punch. We've cast Daniel Brühl to play this role—he is so cunning, and he's such a great actor who has this presence that, even without an army and without an armored suit and without a skilled fighting style, he comes very, very close to undoing them forever."

While keeping the film grounded and realistic, the Russo brothers were